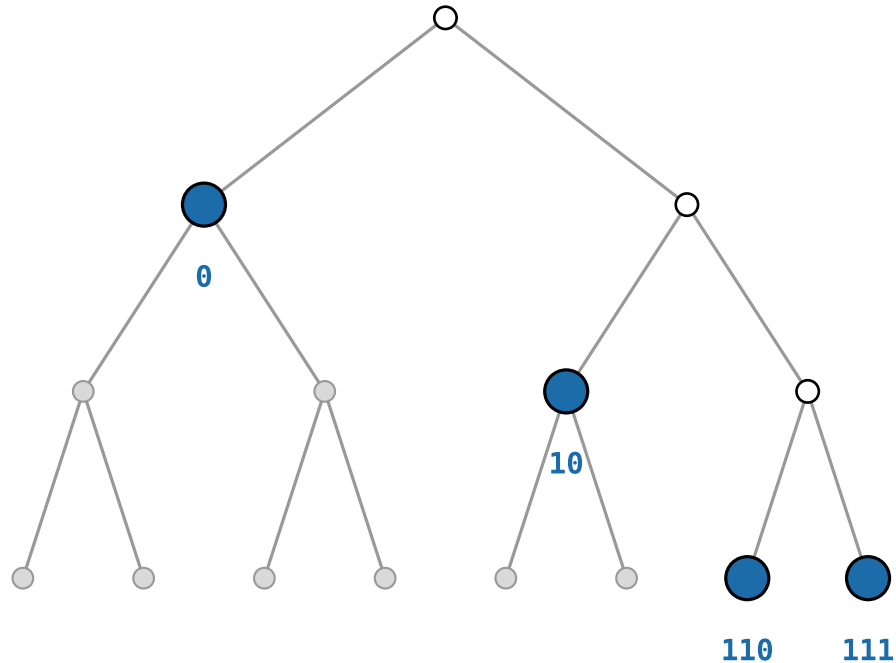


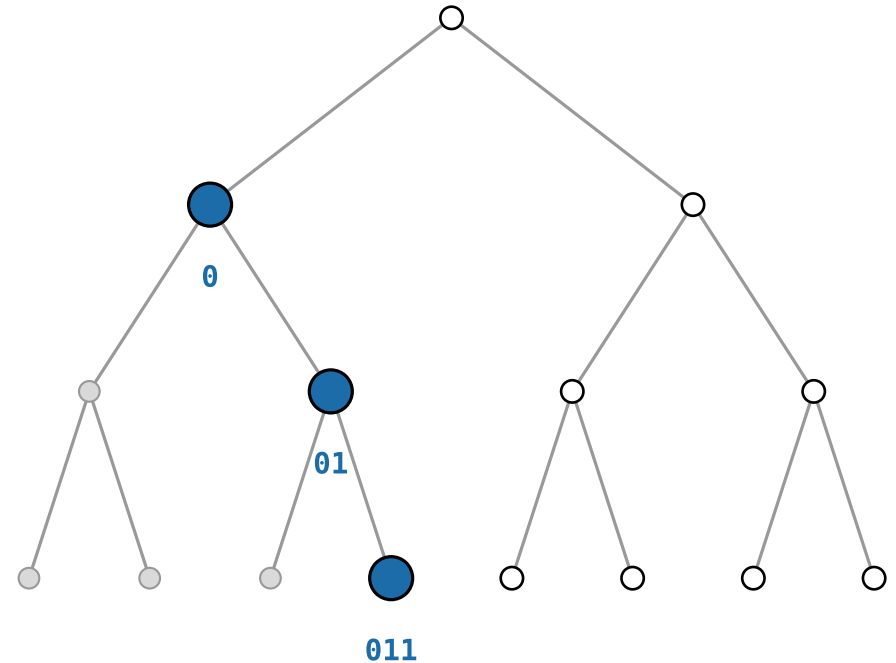
Binary tree view of prefix codes (depth-3 strings shown)

Prefix-free set
 $\mathcal{P} = \{0, 10, 110, 111\}$



No codeword lies on the path to another:
every message is uniquely decodable.

NOT prefix-free
 $\{0, 01, 011\}$



0 is a proper prefix of 01 and of 011:
receiving 011 is ambiguous.